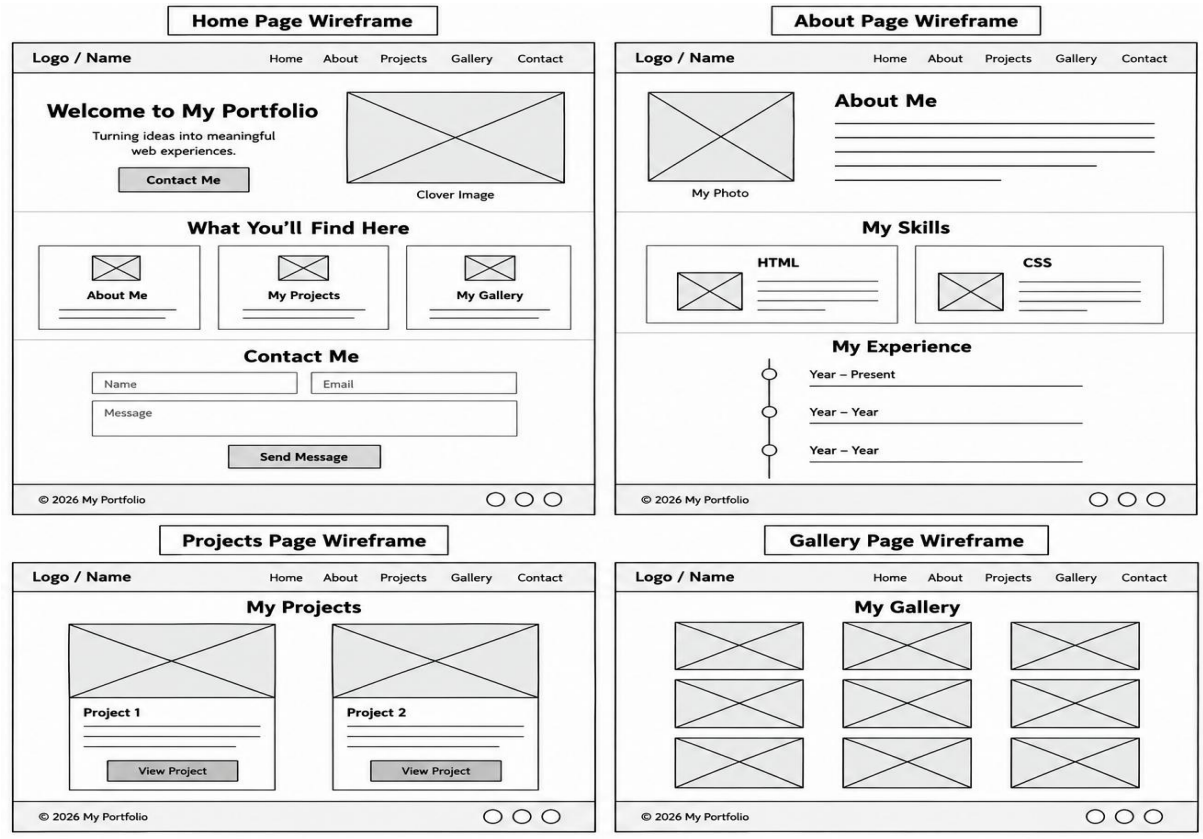
Personal Portfolio – Documentation



1. Beginning and Design Idea

When I first began developing my portfolio, I did not have any concrete ideas about the way that I was going to develop it since I had no experience with web development. But I wanted my website to look elegant and appealing. I also wanted to add some animations to my website to make it more dynamic. Regarding the color scheme, I preferred light colors, such as blue or light blue or pastel shades, for my website since they create a calm atmosphere.

2. Initial Challenge with HTML

Initially, when I started developing my website using HTML , one of the main difficulties I faced was to comprehend the code. It was full of various elements and code snippets, and as a beginner, sometimes it was quite hard to understand which piece of code should come next and how specific code would affect the website as a whole. However, gradually I learned to comprehend the purpose of various parts of the code.

3. Working with CSS

After starting to work with CSS, I found it interesting to see how changes in the code affected the visual appearance of the web page. As an example, having changed the values of various CSS properties, I noticed that some alterations were applied to colors and visual effects on the

web page. Thus, it allowed me to realize the correlation between the CSS code and its results visible in the browser.

4. Four-Page Structure

In creating my portfolio, I made four primary pages; they are Home, About, Projects, and Gallery. The first page introduces the site and tells the visitor what to expect from my portfolio. The second page is about me in particular and includes information about my background, skills, education process, and experiences. The third page features the projects and exercises that I undertook while I was learning. Lastly, the Gallery page is where my own photographs are displayed as a way of including one of my hobbies into the portfolio.

5. Gallery and My Own Photography

Regarding the Gallery page, I wanted to include photographs that I had taken myself. I like to take photos of nature and have a number of them related to the gallery page. Also, using my photos makes me feel more connected to the website and I like to see my own photos as part of the website.

6. Assigned Seed: Clover

My website had a color scheme of blue and light blue. After being assigned “Clover” as my seed, I changed the primary color scheme of my website. I believe that the color green suits the seed of Clover because clover is a plant which has a strong connection to the color green. This change is an improvement to my website since it has more relevance to the seed assigned to me.

7. Responsive Design

Responsive design plays a major role in any website as one can access a website through various devices. A website should work properly on both computers and mobile devices. This means that the layout needs to adjust to different screen sizes. The responsive gallery within my portfolio helped me realize this as the number of images in rows is variable based on screen sizes.

8. What I Learned / What I Would Improve

Another significant lesson that I learned through this project is that developing a website requires patience. As a beginner, I found it important to work step by step. Also, I have learned that mistakes are a part of the learning process. It is essential to practise; otherwise, it will be easy to forget what I have learned.

If I started this portfolio project again, I would work more efficiently and in a more organized way from the beginning. As it was my first experience of developing a website, sometimes I did not understand what stage of the development process needs to be documented via screenshots. If I did the project again, I would plan the work more carefully and take screenshots while making significant changes.

Design System

Colors:
Primary color: `#b7d7a8` – soft green

Dark color: #2f4f3a – dark green

Light color: white

Card color: #f1f7ee – very light green

Font:
I used Arial as the main font throughout the website. I chose it because it is simple, clear, and easy to read.

Spacing:
I used consistent spacing throughout the website. Common values such as 10px, 20px, 30px, and 40px are used for padding, margins, and gaps between different elements and sections.

Technical Explanation

CSS Variables

I used CSS variables to keep the main colors of the website in one place. For example, --primary-color and --dark-color are used throughout the CSS. This makes it easier to change the color theme consistently.

Semantic HTML

I used semantic HTML elements such as <header>, <nav>, and <main> to organize the structure of the website. The <header> contains the main heading and navigation, <nav> contains the links between the pages, and <main> contains the main content of each page.

Advanced Selectors

I used CSS selectors such as nav a:hover, nav a.active, and .contact input:focus. The :hover selector changes the appearance when the mouse is placed over a navigation link, .active shows the current page in the navigation, and :focus makes the selected form field easier to identify.

Animation Timing

I used a fadeIn animation on the hero section with a duration of 0.8 seconds and an ease timing function. The animation gradually changes the opacity and moves the content upward when the page loads.

Accessibility and Responsiveness

Accessibility

I used alternative text for the images in the gallery so that the image content can be described if it cannot be seen. I also used clear labels for the contact form and visible focus styles to make keyboard navigation easier to follow.

Responsiveness

I used media queries to make the website adjust to different screen sizes. The gallery displays three columns on larger screens, two columns on medium screens, and one column on smaller screens. I also adjusted the header, navigation, main content, and hero section for smaller screens.

Problem Solving

Problem 1: Code Placement

As a beginner, I sometimes placed code in the wrong position, which caused the webpage to behave differently from what I expected. I solved this by checking the structure of the code again and moving the code to the correct position.

Problem 2: File Saving

Sometimes I forgot to save the file after making changes, so the changes did not appear in the browser. I learned to save the file before checking the result and then refresh the browser to see the updated webpage.

Problem 3: Unexpected Results

Sometimes I added or changed code but did not get the result that I expected on the webpage. When this happened, I checked the code again, looked for mistakes, and made small changes until I found the problem. This helped me understand the importance of testing the website after making changes.

Reflection

This project was enjoyable for me from start to finish; however, I particularly enjoyed changing the look of the website through CSS. This included experimenting with the effects of CSS on the look of the website. In addition, I enjoyed including some of my own photographs in the Gallery portion of the site. As a beginner, building my own website provided a unique sense of accomplishment and joy.

It was quite difficult for me to learn something entirely new since almost everything that was involved in the process was new to me. One of the difficulties included learning what the code means and where certain pieces of code were supposed to be inserted. Another difficulty was the realization of what type of result will follow the insertion of certain code into the existing one.

Another key point I learned from this assignment is that making mistakes is part of the learning process. If things did not work out the way I planned, then I needed to debug the program and try once again. This helped me realize that consistency is key when trying to enhance my web developing skills.

Prior to embarking on this task, I had zero knowledge regarding web development and had never done anything related to HTML and CSS. Now that I have completed the assignment, I

have been able to learn how websites can be designed and styled. What I have also learned is that there are various things that can be done using CSS in order to alter the design of a website.

In the case where I undertake a similar task, I will make sure that I plan things better at the onset. Additionally, I will invest more time into research to understand the different ways through which the use of HTML and CSS coding can make the website more appealing. There is so much that I would want to learn about different ways of styling the website. I am convinced that with enough experience and proper planning, I can do better in the future.